

8.4.11. Securing non-volatile media for storage

8.4.11.R.01. Rationale

The use of techniques to prevent the storage of classified information on non-volatile media and processes to delete temporary data at logoff or shutdown may sound secure but there is no guarantee that they will always work effectively or will not be bypassed in unexpected circumstances such as a loss of power. As such, agencies need to consider these risks when implementing such a solution.

8.4.11.C.01. Control: System Classification(s): All Classifications; Compliance: SHOULD

Agencies choosing to prevent the storage of classified information on non-volatile media and enforcing scrubbing of temporary data at logoff or shutdown SHOULD:

- assess the security risks associated with such a decision; and
- specify the processes and conditions for their application within the system's SecPlan.

8.4.12. Securing volatile media for storage

8.4.12.R.01. Rationale

If agencies need to conduct a security risk assessment as part of the procedure for storing IT equipment containing media during non-operation hours, they should consider security risks such as:

- an attacker gaining access to the IT equipment immediately after power is removed and accessing the contents of volatile media to recover encryption keys or parts thereof. This is sometimes described as a data remanence attack;
- extreme environmental conditions causing data to remain in volatile media for extended periods after the removal of power; and
- the physical security of the locations in which the IT equipment will reside.

8.4.12.C.01. Control: System Classification(s): All Classifications; Compliance: SHOULD

Agencies securing volatile media for IT equipment during non-operational hours SHOULD:

- disconnect power from the equipment the media resides within;
- assess the security risks if not sanitising the media; and
- specify any additional processes and controls that will be applied within the system's SecPlan.